

Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Policy

VERSION 1.0	EFFECTIVE	NEXT REVIEW	OWNER Principal / Key Management Personnel	APPROVED BY Governing body
-----------------------	-----------	-------------	--	--------------------------------------

PURPOSE AT A GLANCE

This policy explains how [] plans for emergencies and disasters — developing and testing plans with participants and their support networks, training workers, and ensuring supports that are critical to each participant's safety, health and wellbeing continue before, during and after an emergency or disaster.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy supports [] to apply the Emergency and Disaster Management NDIS Practice Standards. It applies to all services and supports delivered by [] and to all employees, contractors and volunteers (**Workers**), who must take full responsibility for understanding and following it. It should be read alongside the related documents in the final section and the corresponding procedures in the Policy Register.

2. Policy aims

[] is committed to ensuring that:

- planning ensures the risks to the health, safety and wellbeing of participants that may arise in an emergency or disaster are considered and mitigated, and that critical supports continue; and
- each participant has access to timely and appropriate support without interruption.

3. Business Continuity, Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Plan

[] maintains a Business Continuity and Disaster Management Plan that sets out the measures in place to enable continuity of the supports critical to each participant's safety, health and wellbeing. It uses the Prevention, Preparedness, Response and Recovery framework and covers preparing for and responding to an emergency or disaster, making changes to participant supports, adapting and rapidly responding to interruptions, and communicating changes to workers, participants and their support networks.

4. Planning with participants

[] develops emergency and disaster management plans, consults participants and their support networks about the plans, and puts them in place. A Client Emergency Plan is completed with each participant. Plans explain how [] will respond to and oversee the response to an emergency or disaster, have periodic review points, and are actively tested and adjusted in the context of a particular kind of emergency — with tests recorded in the Emergency Test Register. Plans are reviewed regularly, with consultation, and communicated to workers, participants and support networks.

5. Training and readiness

Each worker completes Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Training and Infection Prevention and Control Training through a recognised RTO, and is trained in the implementation of the plans. [] takes an 'all hazards' approach — fire, flood, storm, cyber incident, pandemic and infection — maintains emergency systems and evacuation procedures relevant to the region, and uses its best endeavours to ensure essential services continue, delivered by [] and, where relevant, other providers.

6. Definitions

[]
[], ABN [].

Client

A client of [], including an NDIS participant.

Key Management Personnel (KMP)

[], and other key management personnel involved in [] from time to time.

Principal

[].

Legislation Register

The register of legislation, regulations, rules and guidelines maintained by [].

Policy Register

The register of policies of [].

Worker

A permanent, fixed-term or casual member of staff, a contractor or a volunteer engaged by [], including the Principal.

Emergency Plan

An emergency plan prepared by [] for its business, or in collaboration with a participant for the participant's personal safety and wellbeing (the Client Emergency Plan).

7. Related documents and approval

Related documents: Business Continuity and Disaster Management Plan · Client Emergency Plan · Emergency Test Register · Risk Management Policy · COVID-19 Pandemic Management Policy · Infection Control Policy · Human Resources Management Policy · Legislation Register · Policy Register.

Legislation and rules: as set out in the Legislation Register. If any part of this policy is inconsistent with applicable law, it is taken to be amended only to the extent needed to comply.

Approved by	[]
Approval date	
Next scheduled review	
Version	1.0